

Article | 21 July 2026

Webinar: What if... Oil surges back to \$120/bbl?

How bad could it get for energy markets? And what does the spike in oil and natural gas prices mean for Europe's economy and the ECB? Join us on Thursday for the first episode of **What if?** – a new summer webinar series hosted by James Smith exploring what could turn today's market consensus on its head. [Sign up now](#)



A US Military helicopter flies over the Strait of Hormuz, where tensions have escalated over recent days

Oil prices are on the rise as the US-Iran war enters a dangerous new phase and flows through the Strait of Hormuz grind to a renewed halt. So just how bad could it get for energy markets? And what does the spike in oil and natural gas prices mean for Europe's economy and the ECB?

Join ING's economists and strategists for the first episode of **What if?** – a new summer webinar series hosted by James Smith exploring what could turn today's market consensus on its head.

You'll learn:

- ING's base case for oil prices – plus what it would take for crude to go back to its previous 2026 highs or even higher.
- The major drivers of prices, from strategic reserves to Chinese demand.
- Why natural gas prices are rising and how bad it could get.
- The impact of the crisis so far on the eurozone economy.
- Whether the ECB can really hike twice more as markets now expect.

[Sign up here](#)

Details

Date: Thursday 23 July

Time: 09:30 BST/10:30 CEST/16:30 SGT

The webinar will last 30 minutes, including a Q&A session at the end.

The event will take place online, and the waiting room will open 60 minutes ahead of the scheduled start time.

A joining link will be emailed following registration, and you will receive a reminder email 10 minutes before the scheduled start time.

By registering for this event, you'll be signed up to future webinars in this series. You can unsubscribe at any time.

Speakers

- **James Smith** (Developed Markets Economist)
- **Warren Patterson** (Head of Commodities Strategy)
- **Bert Colijn** (Chief Economist, Netherlands)

Next up:

What if... The Fed cuts rates by next summer?

Thursday 6 August
15:00 CEST



What if?

A new summer webinar series exploring what could turn today's market consensus on its head. Brought to you by ING Global Research.



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